

health would always, in some capacity, be dictated by those around me.

I'd like you to think about the extent to which this is true for you. Are you a people-pleaser? Can you think of occasions when not having clear boundaries cost you your financial health? Are there ways in which you've sacrificed your financial stability and peace of mind because you wanted to feel accepted, or because you didn't feel that you could say no to someone else?

This can be one of the issues with our societal reluctance to talk honestly about money. With a lack of accurate information available, we run the risk of making assumptions about what everyone else is working with, which can be damaging to both us and them. After all, the way in which we're all pushed to finance our lifestyles with quick credit means that it's entirely possible to present an affluent or at least comfortable lifestyle on the surface while struggling horribly with money in reality. All of which also means that, without any further insight, people might assume that a hen weekend in Barcelona or even after-work drinks are affordable for you, even when they're not, and can lead to a situation in which you're forced to decide whether to be honest and protect your financial health or to keep up appearances and stick it on a credit card.